

Sedum Solutions — Quoting Checklist

This checklist is subject to change as we learn and grow. The goal is to make sure every quote contains enough information to accurately scope, price, and complete the job without relying on memory.

1. Lead Response

- Home Depot leads must be contacted within **12 hours** or passed.
 - Try to schedule the quoting appointment as quickly as reasonably possible.
 - A quote must be sent **within 3 days of the quoting appointment at the absolute latest**.
 - Ideally, send it sooner. The longer we wait, the more competing quotes the client receives and the less likely we are to get the job.
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2. At the Quoting Appointment

Understand Exactly What They Want

Ask:

- What exactly do you want built, repaired, replaced, or removed?
- What parts of the existing structure are staying?
- What parts are being demolished?
- What does the finished product need to look like?
- Are there specific materials, colours, styles, brands, or finishes you want?
- Are there existing materials we need to match?
- Is the client supplying anything themselves?
- Is there anything they specifically **do not** want included?
- Are there optional items they would like priced separately?

Make sure there is a clearly defined **scope of work** before leaving.

Timeline

Ask:

- When would they like the work completed?
 - Is there a hard deadline?
 - Is there an event, move-in date, sale, inspection, tenant, etc. affecting the timeline?
 - Are they flexible on timing?
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Budget

Ask whether they have a budget or expected price range.

A budget can help determine whether we should be discussing:

- Repair vs. replacement
 - Pressure-treated vs. composite
 - Basic vs. premium finishes
 - Phasing the project
 - Optional items
 - Different design approaches
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3. Measurements

Take **every measurement necessary** for:

- Everything being built
- Everything being demolished
- Everything being replaced
- Anything new work connects to

Depending on the project, check:

- Length
- Width
- Height
- Depth
- Square footage
- Linear footage
- Elevation above grade
- Number of stairs
- Stair rise and run
- Number and spacing of posts
- Existing joist size and spacing
- Beam sizes
- Door/window openings
- Roof dimensions and slope
- Railing lengths
- Material thickness
- Anything unusual or out of square

Do not assume you will remember a measurement later.

If there is any doubt, **measure it!**

4. Draw the Project

Draw a loose plan of what they want built.

It does not need to be a CAD drawing.

The drawing should show enough information that someone who was not at the appointment could understand:

- General shape
- Dimensions
- Stairs

- Posts
- Railings
- Doors/windows
- Existing structures
- New structures
- Important connection points
- Anything unusual

Write measurements directly onto the drawing wherever possible.

5. Existing Conditions

Look carefully at what already exists.

Check for:

- Rot
- Water damage
- Mould/moisture
- Cracked or damaged materials
- Sagging
- Settlement
- Out-of-level surfaces
- Out-of-square framing
- Questionable framing
- Poor foundations/supports
- Drainage problems
- Damaged siding
- Damaged roofing
- Existing flashing problems
- Concrete/masonry conditions

Ask yourself:

Could opening this up reveal additional work that we cannot currently see?

If yes, document it and make sure the quote contains an appropriate assumption/exclusion.

Example:

Price assumes existing framing is structurally sound. Any concealed rot or damage discovered during demolition will be discussed and quoted separately.

6. Utilities and Services

Check for:

- Electrical
- Plumbing
- Gas
- HVAC
- Drainage
- Hose bibs
- Exterior outlets
- Underground utilities

Determine whether anything needs to be:

- Moved
- Disconnected
- Reconnected
- Protected
- Worked around

Determine whether another trade will be required.

7. Access and Logistics

Before leaving, figure out how the job will actually work.

Check:

- Where can we park?
- Can the truck get close to the work area?

- Can the trailer get in?
- Where will materials be delivered?
- Where can materials be stored?
- How far do materials have to be carried?
- How far does demolition debris have to be carried?
- Are there stairs?
- Narrow gates?
- Steep grades?
- Mud/soft ground?
- Landscaping that has to be protected?
- Finished floors that need protection?
- Limited parking?
- Neighbours/shared driveways?
- Property-line issues?
- Pets?
- Occupied areas?
- Restricted working hours?

Also determine whether we will need:

- Ladders
- Scaffolding
- Fall protection
- Excavator
- Jackhammer
- Compactor
- Concrete mixer
- Generator
- Specialty saws/tools
- Dump trailer
- Other rental equipment

Equipment rental needs to be included in the quote.

8. Junk Removal / Demolition

Ask the client whether they want us to handle junk removal.

Determine:

- What is being demolished?
- Approximately how much waste will there be?
- Can anything be reused?
- Can anything be left on site?
- Will we need a dump run?
- Multiple dump runs?
- Dump trailer?
- Waste bin?
- Special disposal?

Remember that junk removal includes more than the dump fee.

Account for:

- Demolition labour
- Loading
- Carrying debris
- Truck/trailer use
- Driving
- Gas
- Dump fees
- Unloading
- Cleanup

9. Materials

Ask what type of materials the client wants.

Clarify things such as:

- Pressure-treated vs. composite
- Wood species
- Decking
- Railing
- Roofing type
- Siding
- Trim
- Paint/stain
- Hardware colour/style
- Finish quality
- Specific brands/products

Check whether anything is:

- Special order
 - Difficult to source
 - Backordered
 - Long lead-time
 - Client supplied
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10. Photos and Video

Take photos of:

- Overall work area
- Every side of the project
- Existing conditions
- Damage
- Framing
- Connection points
- Access route
- Utilities
- Measurements where useful

- Anything unusual

Take a detailed video.

The video should explain:

- What the client wants
- What is being demolished
- What is staying
- What is being built
- Important measurements
- Materials discussed
- Access
- Problem areas
- Potential complications
- The basic construction plan

The video should contain enough information that if somebody else was preparing the quote — or you completely forgot the appointment — they could understand the job **solely from the video, photos, measurements, and drawing.**

11. Permits / Code / Other Trades

Before pricing the job, determine whether we may need:

- Building permit
- Development permit
- Electrical permit
- Plumbing permit
- Engineering
- Utility locate
- Property-line/setback confirmation
- Survey
- Landlord approval
- Condo approval

- Other approvals

Do not assume a permit is unnecessary.

If you aren't sure, check.

Also determine whether we need:

- Electrician
- Plumber
- HVAC contractor
- Roofer
- Excavator
- Concrete contractor
- Engineer
- Surveyor
- Other subcontractor

Clarify who is arranging and paying for them.

12. Build the Material List

Using:

- The drawing
- Measurements
- Photos/video
- Selected materials
- Construction plan

create a complete shopping cart/material list.

For most normal projects, use Home Depot unless there is a reason to purchase elsewhere.

Include **everything required to actually complete the job**, not just the obvious lumber.

Remember:

- Lumber
- Decking
- Sheathing

- Joist hangers
- Structural screws
- Fasteners
- Anchors
- Concrete
- Gravel
- Blocking
- Flashing
- Waterproofing
- Membranes
- Housewrap
- Caulking
- Adhesive
- Shims
- Trim
- Paint/stain
- Primer
- Blades/bits
- Consumables
- Disposal materials
- Delivery

Include extra material for mistakes, defects and cuts.

As a general rule, include **at least one extra of every board**, except things such as stair stringers where that does not make sense.

Use judgement on larger quantities and include a reasonable waste factor.

13. Price Materials

Calculate the total material cost.

Group materials by logical section.

Example:

- Materials — Deck
- Materials — Stairs
- Materials — Railing
- Materials — Roofing
- Materials — Siding

For each section:

1. Calculate actual material cost.
2. Add applicable tax.
3. Add Sedum's material markup/surcharge — normally **at least 15%**.
4. Use the resulting amount as the quoted material price.

The quote does not need to itemize our internal material markup separately.

14. Miscellaneous Costs

Do not forget the small things that are difficult to attach to one material category.

Include an appropriate amount for things such as:

- Screws
- Fasteners
- Consumables
- Blades/bits
- Caulking
- Adhesive
- Small hardware
- Material pickup
- Admin
- Cleanup
- Fuel
- Tool wear
- Minor unexpected material needs

This can appear on the quote as something such as:

Miscellaneous — admin, cleanup & material acquisition

15. Price the Work — Not Just the Labour

Do **not** quote the customer our raw hourly labour cost.

Quote the **job**.

First estimate how much labour the job realistically requires.

Include:

- Setup
- Demolition
- Construction
- Material handling
- Trips
- Cleanup
- Finishing
- Troubleshooting
- Unexpected delays

Then add a buffer.

As a general rule:

1. Estimate the labour you think the job will require.
2. Add at least a few hours for uncertainty.
3. Calculate the internal labour cost.
4. Add approximately **30% or more** when determining the customer-facing labour/job price.

Example

You think a deck will take:

2 people × 8 hours

At \$30/hour internal labour cost:

\$240 × 2 = \$480

But 8 hours is probably optimistic, so price at least:

2 people × 10 hours = \$600 internal labour

Then:

\$600 × 1.30 = \$780 minimum customer-facing labour component

This is an internal calculation.

The quote should normally describe the completed work, for example:

New deck construction — \$780

rather than:

20 hours labour — \$780

16. Before Finalizing the Price

Ask:

What could make this job take longer or cost more than I currently think?

Consider:

- Hidden rot
- Difficult demolition
- Weather
- Access
- Material handling
- Out-of-square existing construction
- Custom fitting
- Unexpected store trips
- Multiple mobilizations
- Drying/curing time
- Waiting for inspections
- Client changes
- Difficult cleanup
- Subcontractor coordination

Price enough margin into the job that a small problem does not turn the project into a loss.

17. Quote Structure

Keep the quote understandable to the client while grouping related costs.

Example

Materials — Deck

Pressure-treated lumber, joist hangers, hardware, etc. — **\$950**

Materials — Stairs

Stringers, treads, hangers, etc. — **\$300**

Old Deck Demolition — \$250

New Deck Construction — \$700

New Stair Construction — \$600

Miscellaneous

Admin, cleanup, material acquisition, consumables, etc. — **\$150**

Junk Removal

Junk hauling, dump fees, fuel, etc. — **\$300**

Subtotal — \$3,250

HST (14%) — \$455

Total — \$3,705

18. Deposit

Charge a portion of the project up front.

The deposit must be **at least enough to cover the materials**.

Whenever reasonable, aim for approximately **50% of the total project price**.

Clearly state the deposit amount and due date in the quote.

Example:

A deposit of \$1,850 is required at least 24 hours before the scheduled project start date.

Clients will sometimes forget, so follow up before the project begins.

Do not purchase project materials until the required deposit has been paid.

19. Before Sending the Quote

Final check:

- Do we understand exactly what the client wants?
- Do we have every necessary measurement?
- Do we have enough photos/video?
- Do we have a usable drawing?
- Do we know what is being demolished?
- Do we know what is staying?
- Do we know what materials they want?
- Have we checked access?
- Have we accounted for junk removal?
- Have we accounted for material pickup/delivery?
- Have we accounted for setup and cleanup?
- Have we accounted for fasteners and miscellaneous materials?
- Have we checked permits?
- Have we considered other trades?
- Have we considered rentals/equipment?
- Have we accounted for potential hidden conditions?
- Have we included appropriate assumptions/exclusions?
- Have we added material markup?
- Have we added sufficient labour buffer and profit?
- Is the deposit enough to cover material purchases?
- Is the deposit due before materials need to be purchased?
- Can someone who was **not at the quoting appointment** look at our documentation and understand exactly how this job is supposed to work?

If the answer to the last question is **no**, the quote is not ready.